Data Card - TMDB Film Collaborations

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Source: TMDB API -> https://api.themoviedb.org/3/discover/movie

Registered scope: A sample of US-origin movies released from 2020-01-01 to 2025-12-31, belonging to Drama or Thriller, with at least 100 votes. For each selected movie, we collect up to six lowest billing-order actors and crew members whose jobs are Director, Producer, or Director of Photography.

Source

The data was collected from the **TMDB API** using:

- /discover/movie for movie discovery;
- /movie/{movie_id}/credits for cast and crew.

Collection method & dates

Collected in Python with requests and Bearer-token authentication. The Discover endpoint was paginated, credits were requested once per movie, responses were cached, and temporary failures were retried. Acquisition date: 21 October 2026 UTC. Details are stored in acquisition_log.json.

Scope & size

The final acquired data contains:

- movies.parquet: **1208 rows × 9 columns**;
- credits.parquet: **14252 rows × 7 columns**.

One movie row represents one selected film. One credit row represents one person-role association for a movie.

Cleaning result: Raw files were kept unchanged. A flagged analysis copy was created. Fourteen movies with fewer than six actors were retained and marked with cast_short_flag. Structural missingness was kept and described with missing_reason; no rows were removed.

Schema

Movies		Credits	
Field	Meaning	Field	Meaning
id	TMDB movie identifier	movie_id	TMDB movie identifier
title	Movie title	person_id	TMDB person identifier
original_title	Original title	person_name	Person name
release_date	Release date	role	actor, director, producer or cinematographer
genre_ids	List of TMDB genre identifiers	department	Original TMDB crew department
original_language	Original language code	job	Original TMDB crew job
vote_count	Number of TMDB votes	billing_order	Actor billing position; not applicable to crew
vote_average	Average TMDB rating		
popularity	TMDB popularity score		

Known biases & limitations

The dataset does not represent the entire US film industry. It excludes movies outside 2020–2025, non-US movies, titles outside Drama or Thriller, movies with fewer than 100 TMDB votes, actors outside the top six billing positions, and crew jobs outside the three selected roles. The genre filter is inclusive, so a movie may belong to Drama, Thriller, or both. The vote threshold favors more visible titles.

Missing credit fields are structural: department and job do not apply to actors, while billing_order does not apply to crew. These values were kept missing and explained with missing_reason; they were not imputed.

Vote_count and popularity are right-skewed, but their highest values were checked and retained as plausible. All years from 2020 to 2025 are represented, although selected movie counts decrease after 2022 and vary by month

License / ToS

Data was obtained from the official TMDB API for academic use. TMDB remains the source, and its Terms of Use and attribution requirements apply. No images or other media were collected.

GDPR note

Credits contain publicly available professional personal data: person_id, person_name, role, and job. Collection was limited to fields needed for film-credit analysis. No biographies, birth dates, images, contacts, social-media data, or other private/sensitive information were collected.